

## 5.a) Etic vs Emic Approach in Anthropological Research

Etic vs Emic approach in anthropology has been a constant debate since the beginning of field as academic discipline.

| Etic                                                                                             | Emic                                                                                               |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <u>Proponents:</u> Marvin Harris, EB Tylor                                                       | <u>Proponents:</u> Franz Boas, Clifford Geertz                                                     |
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Collection of <u>quantifiable data</u></li> </ul>       | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Qualitative data collection.</li> </ul>                   |
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• <u>Objective and unbiased interpretation</u></li> </ul> | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• <u>Subjectivist interpretation of findings</u></li> </ul> |
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• <u>Formation of universal laws</u></li> </ul>           | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• <u>No universal laws can be formed.</u></li> </ul>        |
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• <u>Generalization of findings</u></li> </ul>            | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Findings may or <u>may not be generalized.</u></li> </ul> |

| Etic                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | Emic                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Use of <u>sampling</u>, <u>statistical methods</u> for data collection.</li> <li>• <u>Variables</u> used are those which are <u>unique, distinct</u>.</li> <li>(eg) <u>Leslie White</u> used <u>energy efficiency</u> to <u>evaluate culture change</u>.</li> <li>• <u>Deduction</u> is used.</li> <li>• Used for <u>applied</u>, <u>biological anthro-pology</u>.</li> </ul> | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Use <u>Interviews</u>, <u>participant observation</u>.</li> <li>• <u>Variables</u> are <u>social</u> and <u>hard to quantify</u>.</li> <li>(eg) <u>Geertz</u> used <u>'thick description'</u> to show <u>power dynamics</u> at play <u>between various groups</u>.</li> <li>• <u>Induction</u> is used.</li> <li>• Used for <u>socio-cultural anthropology</u>.</li> </ul> |

Both etic and emic approach complement each other to make anthropological research holistic.